MARIO: THE CYBER HEIST

CLASSIFICATION: **EYES ONLY**
THREAT LEVEL: OMEGA

CHANAKYA UNIVERSITY • OJAS TECH FEST 2026 • OFFICIAL CTF PARTICIPANT GUIDE

■ INCIDENT BRIEFING — OPERATION: RECOVER THE GOLDEN STAR
At **03:14:07 AM**, the Mushroom Kingdom Master Sanctum vault security perimeter collapsed. The kingdom's core power source, **THE GOLDEN STAR**, was exfiltrated by rogue cyber syndicate **'PHANTOM_SHROOM'**. As cyber operatives, your mission is to investigate compromised sectors on the **3D World Map**, analyze forensic evidence, bypass firewalls, defeat Bowser's mainframe shields, and recover the Golden Star.

■■ 1. SECTOR PROGRESSION & FORENSIC WORKBENCHES

SEC	SECTOR NAME	FORENSIC SPECIALIZATION & OBJECTIVES	GATING STATUS
01	**Mushroom Village**	Exif metadata extraction, Wireshark PCAP packet analysis, Linux file permissions & SUID escalation.	0 ■ Unlocked
02	**Dark Forest**	SQL Injection auth bypass, SHA-256 rainbow tables / password cracking, DOM XSS payload sanitization.	2 ■ Required
03	**Haunted Mansion**	Python bytecode decompilation, memory buffer overflow analysis, encrypted firmware string extraction.	5 ■ Required
04	**Koopa HQ**	JWT secret key forgery / privilege escalation, Insecure AWS S3 cloud bucket enumeration.	8 ■ Required
05	**Final Fortress**	**Three-Stage Boss Showdown:** Phase 1 (4 Sector Shields) → Phase 2 (Cyber Trivia) → Phase 3 (Master Flag).	11 ■ Required

■ 2. SCORING SYSTEM & GAME ECONOMY

■ Forensic Points (Score)
Every case cleared awards between **100 to 500 PTS** based on forensic complexity. Scores are registered atomically on the official server ledger.

■ Golden Stars (0 - 12)
Cases 1–11 award 1 Star each. Accumulate stars to dissolve quantum firewalls guarding higher sector islands. Clearing all 11 unlocks Bowser's Fortress.

■ Cyber Coins & 3D ? Blocks
Each investigator starts with **100 Cyber Coins**. Earn more by solving cases or clicking floating 3D Question Blocks on the map. Spend coins to decrypt hints!

■■ Monotonic Competition Timer
High-precision competition clock calibrated with server UTC. Automatically locks the exact millisecond the final Boss flag is verified.

■ 3. SOLO INVESTIGATOR SYSTEM & SESSION PORTABILITY

- **Individual 1-vs-All Format:** Every participant competes independently on their personal laptop or workstation. No squads or team collaboration.
- **Personal Access Code:** When you register, you receive a unique cryptographic access code (e.g., OJAS-W7KP-92RM). Keep it safe!
- **Session Portability:** Resume your mission from any browser or workstation by entering your Access Code. Solves and coins are saved in real-time.

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OFFICIAL TOURNAMENT RULES & CODE OF CONDUCT • REGULATION ID: CTF-REG-2026

■ 4. OFFICIAL COMPETITION REGULATIONS

1. Standard Flag Format: All flags strictly adhere to the standardized structure: FLAG{SAMPLE_FLAG_TEXT}. Flags are strictly **case-sensitive** and must include the outer FLAG{...} wrapper.

2. Anti-Brute-Force Rate Limiting: Automated dictionary attacks, fuzzing, or rapid scripted submissions against the flag submission box trigger automatic IP rate limiting (**maximum 10 attempts per 30 seconds**).

3. Hint Transparency Policy: Unlocking forensic hints deducts Cyber Coins permanently from your individual treasury. Hints are progressive (Tier 1: Investigative Angle → Tier 2: Specific Vector).

4. Deterministic Podium Tie-Breaking: Standings are ranked automatically without arbitrary manual overrides using this strict priority cascade:

1. **Total Forensic Points (Score)** — *Highest score ranks first*
2. **Normal Golden Stars Recovered** — *Most cases cleared ranks higher*
3. **Mission Completion Status** — *Investigators that breached the Boss Fortress rank above active participants*
4. **Total Elapsed Mission Time** — *Faster completion clock ranks higher*
5. **Timestamp of Final Solved Flag** — *Earlier server-recorded solve timestamp breaks final ties*

■■ PROHIBITED ACTIONS (ZERO TOLERANCE — IMMEDIATE DISQUALIFICATION)

- **Infrastructure Attacks:** Do NOT launch Denial-of-Service (DoS/DDoS) floods, SQL injection against platform endpoints, or port scans against the host server. All challenge exploitation is strictly confined to individual case workbenches.
- **Inter-Participant Collusion:** Sharing flags, private keys, solutions, or access codes with other participants is strictly prohibited. This is a 100% individual tournament.
- **Account Hijacking:** Do NOT attempt to brute-force or use another participant's Access Code or session credentials.

■ 5. OPERATIVE QUICKSTART CHECKLIST

- ■ **Step 1 — Register Operative:** Open the tournament portal and enter your detective alias / name to register.
- ■ **Step 2 — Save Access Code:** Keep your personal Access Code safe to resume your session from any device.
- ■ **Step 3 — Inspect 3D Map:** Review the Mission Briefing and begin investigation in Sector 01 (Mushroom Village).
- ■ **Step 4 — Breach Bowser's Fortress:** Accumulate 11 Golden Stars to unlock Sector 05 and defeat the final boss!

TOURNAMENT AUTHORIZATION:
OJAS 2026 ORGANIZING COMMITTEE
Chanakya University Cyber Security Directorate • Bangalore, India

STATUS: VERIFIED & ACTIVE
OFFICIAL COMPETITION BRIEFING
Chanakya University Tech Fest